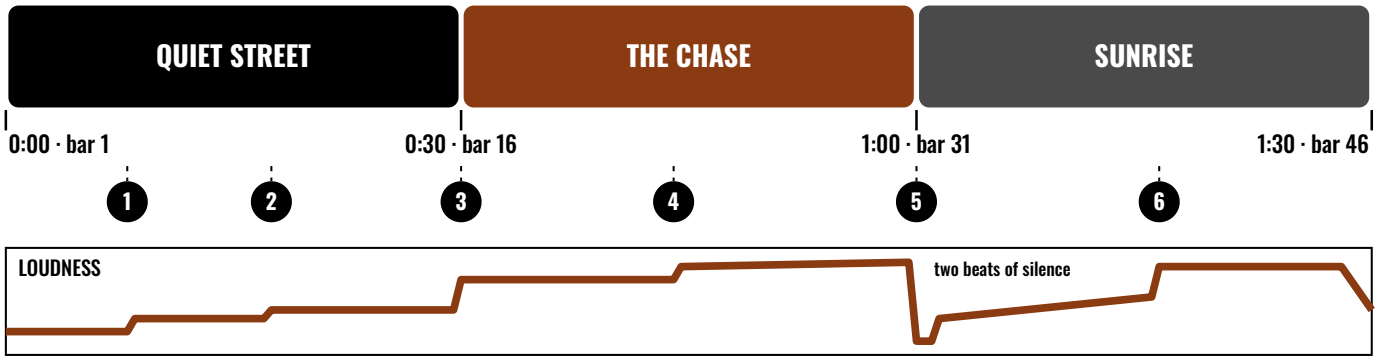
HUDSON BEAT




# SCORE THE PICTURE
# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

DMP2 · mood · timing · hit points · markers · intro slides

GRADES 9–12 · 7 CLASS PERIODS · 24 PAGES + 18-SLIDE DECK

# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

How to use this resource

START HERE

Teacher

## WHAT THIS IS ·

A 7-class-period scoring project for high school music technology. Each student chooses a 2–3 minute video clip and composes an original soundtrack for it in Logic Pro: music that matches the mood, pacing and emotional arc of the picture, with at least some elements timed to specific visual moments, called hit points. It is an open-ended project from my Digital Music Production 2 course (focus: scoring and sync), and the projects in that course can be taught in any order.

## QUICK START ·

1. Read the pacing guide (page 5) and my teacher notes (pages 6–7).
2. Decide how students will find a clip they may use (page 4): no video is included.
3. Print the student pages (pages 13–23), one set per student.
4. Open the intro deck and read the speaker notes for Class 1.

## THE INTRO DECK ·

Every slide has a class: Class 1 (slides 1–6), Class 2 (slides 7–11), Class 3 (slide 12), Class 4 (slide 13), Class 6 (slides 14–16) and Class 7 (slides 17–18). Class 5 is a working day with no new slide. Every slide has speaker notes.

Fonts: the deck uses Oswald and Source Sans 3 (free on Google Fonts, built into Google Slides). If PowerPoint or Keynote shows a different font, install the two fonts or present the PDF copy, which shows the intended look.

## WHAT'S INSIDE ·

| PART | PAGES | USE |
|---|---|---|
| **Teacher pages** | pages 2–12 | How to use, overview, choosing a clip, pacing, teacher notes, what changed, Logic reference, sync guide, composing to picture, worked example |
| **Student pages** | pages 13–23 | Clip log, Watch notes, Score plan, Cue sheet, Sync log, project sheet (3 pages), rubric, vocabulary, feedback planner |
| **Intro deck (separate file)** | deck | 18 slides, .pptx + PDF, speaker notes on every slide |

### NO VIDEO OR AUDIO INCLUDED

No video, audio, films, games or songs are included. Students use their own clip, or one they may use from a site such as YouTube or Vimeo, and choose it themselves (page 4), so you know exactly where every picture came from.

## MAKE IT FIT YOUR CLASS ·

- **Clips:** students may film their own, so the project also works with no downloads at all.
- **Easier or harder:** my variations on page 6.
- **Feedback board:** my sheets use Padlet for the three questions; any class board works.
- **Grading:** my rubric, /25, the average of the student's and your score (page 21).

### IN ONE SENTENCE

Students pick a clip, study it, mark its key moments, compose a score that fits and hits them, and present the result.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Project overview

**OVERVIEW**

DMP2 · Open-Ended

**FROM MY DMP2 PROJECT MENU**

**Music for Visual Media** · Open-Ended · Scoring & Sync
Score a video clip with an original soundtrack. Match mood, pacing, and timing to the visuals.

## WHAT STUDENTS MAKE ·

One Logic Pro score for a 2–3 minute video clip, with at least some musical elements timed to the picture and, if they like, sound effects. They hand in a bounced .mp3 or .wav, the zipped .logicx project, and a Padlet post with three feedback questions, then show the video with their music and talk through their choices.

## WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

This connects music production to real-world application in film, TV, games, and advertising. Builds synchronization skills, emotional storytelling through music, and arrangement for narrative purposes.

## STANDARDS ·

Supports the National Core Arts Standards for Music (Music Technology, high school): refining original work (MU:Cr3.1), presenting it (MU:Pr6.1) and responding to it (MU:Re7.2).

## GOALS ·

- Compose music that serves a visual narrative
- Develop synchronization skills — timing music to visual cues
- Explore mood, atmosphere, and pacing through musical choices
- Optionally incorporate sound effects to enhance the audio-visual experience

## AT A GLANCE ·

| | |
|---|---|
| **Grades** | 9–12: the second-year course, after a first year of Logic Pro basics |
| **Length** | 7 class periods: choose and study, plan, three working days, bounce, present |
| **Software** | Logic Pro: movie import, markers, SMPTE time, software instruments, tempo, volume automation, bounce |
| **You supply** | Video clips (students' own, or ones they may use), headphones, a feedback board, and speakers if you can |
| **Assessment** | My rubric, 5 categories scored 1–5, /25; final grade = average of the student's and the teacher's score (page 21) |

**BEFORE THEY START**

Students should already know how to open a project, add software instruments, and save, bounce and zip in Logic. The Logic quick reference (page 9) covers every tool this project uses.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Setup and choosing a clip

**SETUP**

Teacher

## YOU NEED ·

- **A Mac with Logic Pro** for each student (a current version), and **headphones**. Speakers help for the final check that the music and the picture feel right together.
- **A video clip for every student**: their own footage, or one they may use. Nothing is included.
- **A place to submit** an .mp3 or .wav and a zipped .logicx project (your class page).
- **A feedback board** for the three questions (my sheets use Padlet).
- **Printed student pages**, one set each (pages 13–23).

## BEFORE CLASS 1 ·

- [ ] Decide how clips will be chosen: your own footage, ones students find, or a short list you provide (my easier variation).
- [ ] Read the terms of the site students will use, so you can tell them what they may do with a clip.
- [ ] Pick one short scene you may show, for slide 2: first with the sound off, then with its score.
- [ ] Print the student pages; set up the submission spot and the feedback board.

## CHOOSING A CLIP ·

My project says: your own, or from YouTube or Vimeo. Page 13 is the student log for either.

- **Your own footage.** A phone video, a school project, or screen capture of a game the student plays. No source questions, and the student already knows the story.
- **A clip you give them.** Provide 3–5 clips you may use and let students choose, as my easier variation says.
- **A clip they find.** Look for sites and licenses that allow reuse, and have the student write the source on the Clip log.

### FIVE CHECKS FOR ANY CLIP

- Does it run 2–3 minutes, with 1–2 of them worth scoring?
- Does it have a clear mood a student can name?
- Does it have a few obvious moments to hit?
- Is it simple enough (one place, a few cuts)?
- Does the student know where it came from?

### RIGHTS AND CREDIT

Clips belong to their makers. Scoring a clip for a class exercise is different from posting the finished video online. Check the clip site's terms before anyone posts publicly, and credit the maker. This kit gives no legal advice and includes or links to no clip.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

**PACING**

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

| CLASS | MY PLAN | TEACHER MOVES | DECK | STUDENT PAGES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **CLASS 1** | **Class 1:** Introduction. Students select and import their video. Study the clip. | Slides 1–6: the hook (a scene with the sound off, then on), what a score does, the seven classes, steps 1 and 2, and choosing a clip. Hand out the project sheet, the Clip log and the Watch notes. | Slides 1–6 | p. 13, p. 14, p. 18, p. 19, p. 20, p. 22 |
| **CLASS 2** | **Class 2:** Plan the score — mark key moments, decide on mood and instrumentation. | Slides 7–11: the timeline, a live demo of markers in Logic, bars and seconds, the score plan, shaping the dynamics. Then students fill in the Score plan and the Cue sheet. | Slides 7–11 | p. 15, p. 16, p. 10 |
| **CLASS 3** | **Classes 3–5:** Working days — compose, layer, and sync the score. | Slide 12: compose, starting with the backbone. Then work time. | Slide 12 | p. 17 |
| **CLASS 4** | | Slide 13: sync and refine; check each hit point against the picture. Then work time. | Slide 13 | — |
| **CLASS 5** | | Full working day: layer, sync and shape the dynamics. Ask each student to play you one hit point and tell you where it lands. | No new slides | — |
| **CLASS 6** | **Class 6:** Final mix, bounce, sync audio to video. Prepare presentations. | Slides 14–16: finalize and bounce, what you turn in, the rubric. Students self-score, bounce and post their three questions. | Slides 14–16 | p. 21, p. 23 |
| **CLASS 7** | **Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback. | Slides 17–18: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions. | Slides 17–18 | p. 23 |

### THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

From my common struggles: steer students to a clip with 1–2 minutes of actual scored content. Slide 6 and the clip checks on page 4 are your script, and page 13 is where students record where their clip comes from.

### CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Slides 12 and 13 open Classes 3 and 4; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and ask: where is your next hit point, and what does the music do there?

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## WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

This connects music production to real-world application in film, TV, games, and advertising. Builds synchronization skills, emotional storytelling through music, and arrangement for narrative purposes.

## COMMON STUDENT STRUGGLES ·

- Students pick clips that are too long or too complex. Encourage 1–2 minutes of actual scored content within the 2–3 minute window.
- Students compose music they like rather than music that fits the video. Keep redirecting to the visuals.
- Synchronization is hard. Show them how to use markers in Logic and count frames.
- Students forget about dynamic range — everything is the same volume the whole time.

## SUGGESTED VARIATIONS ·

**Easier:** Provide 3–5 pre-selected video clips to choose from. Shorter clips (60–90 seconds) reduce overwhelm.

**More Advanced:** Require at least 3 specific sync points. Add a requirement for original sound effects alongside the score.

### WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH EACH STRUGGLE

- Clips too long or complex: slide 6, the clip checks on page 4 and the Clip log (page 13).
- Music they like, not music that fits: the Watch notes (page 14) and the Score plan (page 15) start from the picture.
- Sync is hard: the markers demo (slide 8), the sync guide (page 10) and the Cue sheet (page 16).
- Same volume the whole time: slide 11 and the dynamics row of the Score plan (page 15).

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## SUGGESTED RESOURCES ·

| MY LIST | IN THIS KIT |
|---|---|
| YouTube and Vimeo for royalty-free video clips | Not included: no video is included or linked here, because clips belong to their makers. Page 4 shows how to choose a clip students may use, and page 13 is where each student records where theirs came from. |
| Film scoring examples on YouTube | Not included: search by title. My own scoring-to-picture guidance is on page 11, and slide 2 and the notes for Class 1 say how to use a scene you may show, first with the sound off and then with its score. |
| Logic Pro markers tutorial for sync points | Not included: no tutorial is in the materials this kit is built from. Page 11 (my “mark your moments” advice), page 10 and page 9 cover markers, SMPTE time and frames; add your own tutorial link. |

## HOW TO GRADE ·

- My rubric: five categories, each scored 1–5, /25 (page 21). Students score themselves first; the final grade is the average of their score and yours.

*Suggestions from this kit, not part of my rubric:*

- Technical Skill: ask the student to point to three markers in the Marker track and say which moment each one marks.
- Composition & Structure: look for a shape that follows the picture. Does the music change where the scene changes, and is there a quiet moment as well as a loud one?
- Sound Design & Mix Quality: play the finished video once with the sound off and once on. Check that the clip’s own audio is muted and that dialogue or effects in the clip do not fight the score.
- Documentation & Presentation: the cue sheet (page 16) and the Sync log (page 17) are the evidence. My rubric mentions reflection, so you may want to ask for a sentence or two.

## NOTES / OBSERVATIONS ·

This is one of the most rewarding projects when students nail the sync. Consider showing a before/after of a clip with and without music.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

What changed from the original

**CHANGES**

Teacher

This kit is built from three of my documents: the **Project Sheet & Rubric**, the **Teacher Notes** and the **Music for Visual Media** entry on my DMP2 project menu. This page lists every change to my wording, so you know exactly what is mine and what was added.

## WORDING CHANGES ·

- My LMS name is written as “your class page” (checklist items 1 and 2).
- Page numbers are added to steps 1, 2, 3 and 5 (the Clip log, Watch notes, Score plan, Cue sheet and Sync log).
- My three resources are not included (page 7). No video clip, list or tutorial is included, and no 3–5 clip list was in my materials.
- Page 11 is my “Composing to Picture” advice from my Spooky Tunes sheet; the last sentence (about its reverb buses) is left out.
- My pacing guide’s “Classes 3–5” row spans the Class 3, 4 and 5 rows, so each class can name its slides.
- Layout only: the rubric’s Name and Date lines moved to the top; its Notes box became ruled lines.
- The intro deck shortens my wording (full wording on pages 18–20): slide 5 shortens steps 1 and 2, slide 10 shortens step 3, slide 12 shortens step 4, slide 13 shortens step 5, and slide 14 shortens step 6.

## KEPT AS I WROTE IT ·

Everything else from my three documents is kept as I wrote it: the overview, goals, the five vocabulary terms, the five requirements, steps (apart from the page numbers), tips, checklist and file name (“Your Name – Music for Visual Media”), the rubric (five categories scored 1–5, /25, the average of the student’s and the teacher’s score), what the project reinforces, the four common struggles, the variations, my day-by-day pacing and my closing note, and the project menu entry quoted on page 3. No requirement or rubric row is added.

## NEW IN THIS KIT ·

Everything else is new and supports my sheets without changing them (page 11 is from my other materials, as listed above): how to use the kit, the overview and setup pages (including how to choose a clip students may use), the teacher moves and slide numbers in the pacing guide, the grading suggestions, the Logic quick reference, the sync and timing guide, the worked example (an invented 90-second scene described on paper, not a video), the Clip log, Watch notes, Score plan, Cue sheet and Sync log, the vocabulary page, the presentation planner and the intro deck. None of these adds a requirement or a rubric row.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Logic quick reference

**SETUP**

Teacher + student

Everything students need in Logic for this project, in one table. Demonstrate markers (slide 8) and then let students work. Names are from current Logic Pro versions.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Open the clip** | File › Movie › Open Movie, then choose the video file. The picture shows in a movie window; the clip's own sound arrives as a track you can mute. |
| **Frame rate** | Project Settings › Synchronization › Frame Rate. Match the video's rate (often 24, 25 or 30) so markers and timecode line up. |
| **Read the time** | Switch the LCD to show SMPTE time (Control-click the display for the choices): hours:minutes:seconds:frames. |
| **Markers** | View › Show Global Tracks, then use the Marker track. Stop on a key moment, add a marker at the playhead and give it a name, such as "pop" or "cut". |
| **Set the tempo** | Click the tempo in the LCD and type a number, or draw changes on the Tempo global track. A bar is 4 × 60 ÷ tempo seconds (page 10). |
| **Snap and grid** | Set Snap to Bar, Beat or Division, so regions land on the grid. Turn Snap off to nudge by smaller steps. |
| **Software instruments** | Click an empty track, choose Software Instrument, and pick a sound in the Library. Start with one pad or bass as the backbone, then layer in detail. |
| **Volume automation** | Press A to show automation, choose Volume and draw swells and dips. This is how a score gets quiet before a big moment. |
| **Sound effects** | Record your own sounds, or build effects with a software instrument. Place each one at a marker. |
| **Mute the clip's audio** | Mute or delete the video's own audio track, so the original soundtrack does not play under yours. |
| **Bounce** | File › Bounce › Project or Section (Command-B), MP3 or WAV. File › Export › Audio to Movie puts the music on the video, or you can play the video and the bounce together. |
| **Zip the project** | In Finder, Control-click the .logicx and choose Compress. |

### VERSION NOTE

Menu names are from current Logic Pro versions; older versions may differ slightly. Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc., named only to describe what the project needs. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

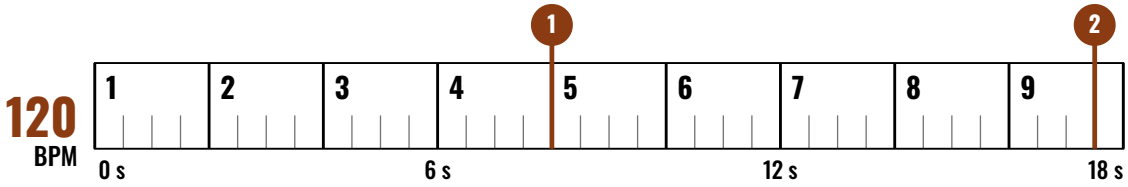
Sync and timing guide

**SYNC GUIDE**

Teacher + student

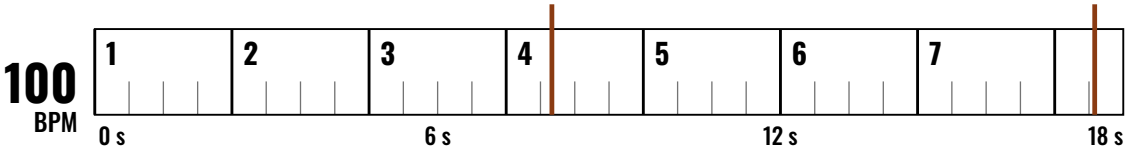
My notes say sync is hard: show students how to use markers and count frames. This page is the explanation to project or print. The numbers use an invented scene at 120 BPM in 4/4.

### 120 BPM: one bar is 2 seconds




Hit 1 at 0:08 lands on bar 5, beat 1. Hit 2 at 0:17.5 lands on bar 9, beat 4.

### 100 BPM: one bar is 2.4 seconds




Slow to 100 BPM and hit 1 falls 3.33 bars in, between beats.

## SECONDS AND BARS ·

| BPM | ONE BEAT | ONE BAR | BARS/MIN |
|---|---|---|---|
| 80 | 750 ms | **3.00 s** | 20.0 |
| 90 | 667 ms | **2.67 s** | 22.5 |
| 100 | 600 ms | **2.40 s** | 25.0 |
| 120 | 500 ms | **2.00 s** | 30.0 |
| 140 | 429 ms | **1.71 s** | 35.0 |

One bar in 4/4 = 4 × 60 ÷ BPM seconds. A hit at time t is in bar t ÷ (bar length) + 1.

## COUNTING FRAMES ·

| VIDEO | ONE FRAME |
|---|---|
| 24 frames per second | 41.7 ms |
| 25 frames per second | 40.0 ms |
| 30 frames per second | 33.3 ms |

Timecode is hours:minutes:seconds:frames. At 24 fps, 0:17.5 is 00:00:17:12, or frame 420. Match the project's frame rate to the video's.

## FOUR WAYS TO HIT A MOMENT ·

| | |
|---|---|
| **On the beat** | The hit lands exactly on a beat or the start of a bar. Easiest to feel; use it for the big moments. |
| **Just before it** | A short run-up or pickup leads into the moment, so the music arrives as the picture does. |
| **A stinger** | One short sound on the exact frame, such as a bell, a hit or a rise, over a quieter bed of music. |
| **Silence** | The music stops, so the picture speaks alone. Often the strongest hit of all. |

## MOOD: FIRST IDEAS ·

| | |
|---|---|
| **Tense** | slow pulse, low register, sparse, notes held and unresolved |
| **Joyful** | major key, brighter register, steady and light |
| **Mysterious** | quiet, lots of space, unusual sounds, reverb |
| **Sad** | slow, minor key, soft, simple melody |
| **Excited** | fast, rhythmic, rising lines, getting louder |

Rules of thumb, not laws. Trust your ears and the picture.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Composing to picture

**TEACHER + STUDENT**

Classes 1-2

From the teacher's own materials: the advice I give my own students when they score a picture for the first time. Project it, or hand it out on Class 1 or 2, next to the Watch notes (page 14) and the Cue sheet (page 16).

## COMPOSING TO PICTURE ·

| | |
|---|---|
| **Watch before you build** | Play the clip twice without touching Logic. What moments stand out? Where does the energy change? What would a sound do to that moment? Write notes before you open a single plug-in. |
| **Mark your moments** | Add markers in Logic at the timestamps where you want something to happen. A footstep. A sudden silence. A swell. Having the map in advance stops you from improvising past the moments that matter. |
| **Silence is a tool** | If nothing is playing for a moment and then a sound enters, the entry feels enormous. Silence is not dead air; it is tension. Use it deliberately. |
| **Let the picture breathe** | You do not need to fill every second with sound. Sparse music over a quiet visual can be more unsettling than a wall of noise. Less is often more here. |
| **Match the energy** | If the picture gets more intense, your music should respond. Build toward moments of tension and release from them. |

### TRY THIS IN CLASS 1

Play a scene you may show to the class with no comment. Then ask: what would you expect to hear if this were a film? Take answers aloud before anyone opens Logic.

### WHERE IT CONNECTS

- Markers: demo on slide 8, then the Sync log (page 17).
- Silence and space: the dynamics picture on slide 11.
- Hit points: the Sync guide (page 10).

### ASK YOUR STUDENTS

- Which moment in your clip would feel biggest if the music stopped?
- Where are you filling space that the picture does not need filled?
- Does your music follow the picture, or just play alongside it?

Film scoring examples are not included. Search by title for a scene you may show.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

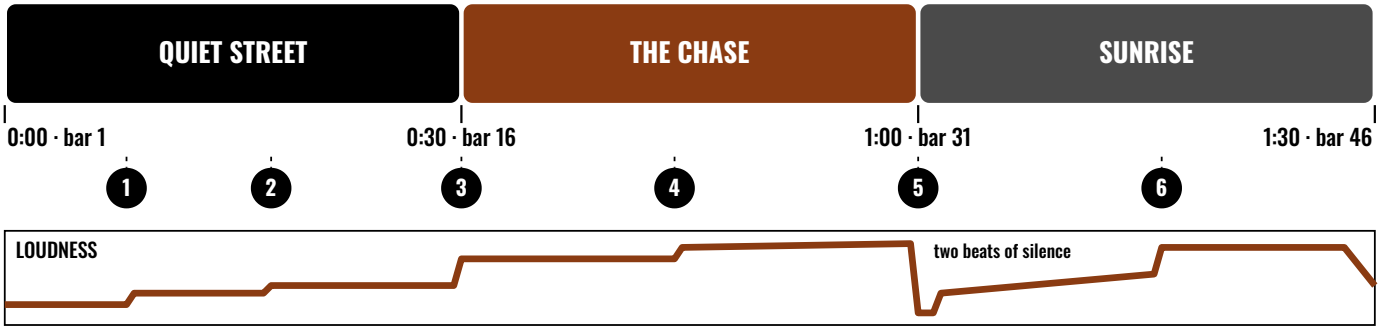
EXAMPLE

Worked example · an invented scene

Teacher

An **invented 90-second scene, described on paper**: no video or audio is included, so the numbers are easy to check. Students' clips will differ.

## 1 · THE SCENE AND ITS HIT POINTS ·




Three scenes of 30 seconds each. At 120 BPM one bar is 2 seconds, so the scene is 45 bars long and each scene is 15 bars.

## 2 · THE CUE SHEET ·

| # | TIME | TIMECODE (24 FPS) | BAR.BEAT | ON SCREEN | THE MUSIC |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | 0:08 | 00:00:08:00 | 5.1 | A door opens | Low pad swells in |
| **2** | 0:17.5 | 00:00:17:12 | 9.4 | She sees the balloon | One bell note |
| **3** | 0:30 | 00:00:30:00 | 16.1 | Cut to the chase | Drums enter, tempo feel doubles |
| **4** | 0:44 | 00:00:44:00 | 23.1 | Turns the corner | Melody steps up a third |
| **5** | 1:00 | 00:01:00:00 | 31.1 | The balloon pops | Everything stops for two beats |
| **6** | 1:16 | 00:01:16:00 | 39.1 | The sun comes up | Full band returns, bright and wide |

### 3 · READING A ROW

Hit 2 is at 17.5 s. 17.5 ÷ 0.5 = 35 beats. 35 ÷ 4 = 8 bars and 3 beats, so it is bar 9, beat 4. In timecode it is 17 s and 12 frames at 24 fps.

### 4 · THE SHAPE OF THE SCORE

Scene 1 is quiet and sparse. Scene 2 is loud and driving until the pop at 1:00, then two beats of silence. Scene 3 returns bright. The loudness curve on this page is the plan (slide 11).

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Clip log

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

**Clip title or description:** _____

**Where it came from (my own footage, or the site and link):** _____

**Who made it:** _____ **Length:** _____ **Frame rate:** _____

**I will score from** _____ **to** _____ **(1–2 minutes of real scored content)**

## IS THIS CLIP A GOOD CHOICE? ·

- ☐ It runs 2–3 minutes, and 1–2 minutes of it are worth scoring
- ☐ I can name its mood in a word or two
- ☐ It has a few clear moments I can hit
- ☐ It is simple enough: one place, a few cuts, not too many characters
- ☐ I know where it came from, and I may use it for this class project
- ☐ I muted the clip's own music, so only my score plays

## WHY I CHOSE IT ·

_____

_____

_____

## CREDIT AND RIGHTS NOTE ·

If I share my finished video outside class, I will check the terms of the site the clip came from, and I will credit the person who made it.

**Credit line:** _____

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Watch notes

Classes 1–2

Name _____ Date _____

My tip: watch the video at least 5 times before you start composing. Use a different job for each viewing and write what you notice.

| WATCH | WHAT TO LOOK FOR | WHAT I NOTICED |
|---|---|---|
| **1** | Just watch. What happens? What is the story? | |
| **2** | Mood: what is the feeling? Colors, light, faces. | |
| **3** | Pacing: how fast are the cuts? Where does it speed up or slow down? | |
| **4** | Key moments: write the time of each big change or action. | |
| **5** | Sound: what do you hear in the clip itself? What is missing? | |

**The mood in three words:** _____

**The pacing in one sentence:** _____

**The emotional arc (how the feeling changes from start to end):** _____

_____

**Where I might use silence:** _____

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Score plan

STUDENT

Class 2

Name _____ Date _____

Step 3: decide where the music builds, drops, shifts and hits visual cues. One row per scene or section of your clip. Start from what the picture does, not from the music you like.

| SCENE AND TIME | MOOD | INSTRUMENTS AND SOUNDS | TEMPO AND KEY | LOUDNESS: QUIET, MEDIUM, LOUD, AND HOW IT CHANGES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |

**The backbone I will build first:** _____

**My main musical idea (a melody, a rhythm or a sound):** _____

**Where the music is silent or very quiet, and why:** _____

**Sound effects I might add (optional):** _____

**CHECK BEFORE YOU COMPOSE**

Does my plan change at the places the picture changes? Does it have a quiet part and a loud part?

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Cue sheet

**STUDENT**

Class 2

Name _____ Date _____

**Tempo:** _____ **BPM. One bar =** _____ **seconds (4 × 60 ÷ BPM). Frame rate:** _____

Mark every hit point on the video with a marker in Logic, then list it here. Use the markers to read the time. Bar.beat = the bar and beat where the music should hit.

| # | TIME (M:SS) | TIMECODE | BAR.BEAT | WHAT HAPPENS ON SCREEN | WHAT THE MUSIC DOES |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | |
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**TIP**

Start with at least three hit points. If a hit does not land on a beat, try a different tempo, or hit the moment with a stinger instead (page 10).

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Sync log

Classes 3–6

Name _____ Date _____

Step 5: for each hit point on your cue sheet, play it with the picture. Does the music arrive with the moment? Write how many frames early or late, then fix it.

| HIT # | PLANNED BAR.BEAT | ON THE MOMENT? | EARLY (-) OR LATE (+), IN FRAMES | FIXED? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| 2 | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| 3 | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| 4 | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| 5 | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| 6 | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| 7 | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| 8 | | ☐ | | ☐ |

## DYNAMICS CHECK ·

- ☐ There is a quiet part and a loud part
- ☐ The loud parts are loud because of the picture
- ☐ I used silence or space at least once
- ☐ My music is not the same level the whole time

## MIX CHECK ·

- ☐ I listened with headphones and with the clip on
- ☐ The clip's own music is muted
- ☐ Any sound effects sit at their markers
- ☐ The video plays from the start with my music

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Name _____ Date _____

# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Digital Music Production | *Open-Ended Project* | 7 class periods

## OVERVIEW ·

Score a video. Choose a 2–3 minute video clip and compose an original soundtrack in Logic Pro that complements the visuals. Your music should match the mood, pacing, and emotional arc of the video — and at least some elements should be timed to specific visual moments.

## GOALS ·

- Compose music that serves a visual narrative
- Develop synchronization skills — timing music to visual cues
- Explore mood, atmosphere, and pacing through musical choices
- Optionally incorporate sound effects to enhance the audio-visual experience

## KEY VOCABULARY ·

| | |
|---|---|
| **Scoring** | Writing music designed to accompany and enhance visual media |
| **Synchronization (Sync)** | Aligning musical events with specific visual moments on screen |
| **Mood** | The emotional tone that music creates — tense, joyful, mysterious, etc. |
| **Sound Design** | Creating or selecting sound effects that enhance the visual experience |
| **Hit Point** | A specific moment in a video where the music emphasizes a visual event |

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Project sheet · requirements and steps



Name _____ Date _____

## REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Choose a 2–3 minute video clip (your own or from YouTube/Vimeo)
- ☐ Compose a fully formed piece of music that complements the visuals
- ☐ At least some musical elements must be timed to the visuals
- ☐ Sound effects are optional but encouraged
- ☐ Export your composition as .mp3 or .wav and sync it to the video for presentation

## STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Choose your video** — Find a 2–3 minute clip that inspires you. Import it into Logic. (Clip log: page 13)
2. **Study the video** — Watch it multiple times. Note the mood, pacing, and key visual moments. (Watch notes: page 14)
3. **Plan your score** — Decide where the music builds, drops, shifts, and hits visual cues. (Score plan: page 15; cue sheet: page 16)
4. **Compose** — Build your score in Logic. Start with the backbone and layer in detail.
5. **Sync and refine** — Fine-tune timing to the visuals. Add sound effects if desired. (Sync log: page 17)
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your audio and prepare the video with your music for presentation
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Project sheet · tips and checklist



Name _____ Date _____

## TIPS FOR SUCCESS ·

- Watch the video at least 5 times before you start composing. You need to know it inside and out.
- Use markers in Logic to flag key visual moments you want to hit.
- Your music doesn't have to fill every second. Silence and space can be powerful.
- Watch movie trailers and film scores for inspiration on how music and visuals interact.

## SUBMISSION CHECKLIST ·

- ☐ Bounced .mp3 or .wav uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Zipped .logicx project file uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Files named correctly: "Your Name – Music for Visual Media"
- ☐ Video with synced audio ready for presentation
- ☐ Padlet post created with your 3 feedback questions
- ☐ Answered at least 2 questions on classmates' Padlet posts during presentations

## NOTES ·

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Rubric

**RUBRIC**

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

## GRADING RUBRIC /25

Music for Visual Media | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

| Category | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY** | Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés | Some creative ideas but largely predictable | Shows originality; experiments with sound or style | Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent | Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive |
| **TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE** | Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools | Basic tool use with frequent errors | Competent workflow; uses tools correctly | Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts | Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems |
| **COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE** | Disorganized; no clear form or direction | Some structure present but underdeveloped | Clear, cohesive form with logical sections | Engaging structure with dynamic progression | Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc |
| **SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY** | Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix | Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ | Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix | Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix | Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix |
| **DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION** | Missing or incomplete; no reflection | Minimal documentation with little insight | Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection | Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection | Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery |

| | |
|---|---|
| Student Score: _____ / 25 | Teacher Score: _____ / 25 |
| **Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25** | |

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Key vocabulary

**STUDENT**

Vocabulary

Name _____ Date _____

The five words from your project sheet, with my definitions. Rewrite each in your own words, then show where it happens in your own project.

**SCORING** — Writing music designed to accompany and enhance visual media

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my video:** _____

**SYNCHRONIZATION (SYNC)** — Aligning musical events with specific visual moments on screen

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my video:** _____

**MOOD** — The emotional tone that music creates — tense, joyful, mysterious, etc.

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my video:** _____

**SOUND DESIGN** — Creating or selecting sound effects that enhance the visual experience

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my video:** _____

**HIT POINT** — A specific moment in a video where the music emphasizes a visual event

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my video:** _____

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# MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Present and get feedback

**STUDENT**

Classes 6–7

Name _____ Date _____

**FROM YOUR PROJECT SHEET, STEP 7**

**Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

## MY THREE FEEDBACK QUESTIONS ·

Ask about things you really want to know, not yes-or-no questions.

**Question 1:** _____

**Question 2:** _____

**Question 3:** _____

## CLASSMATES' QUESTIONS I ANSWERED (AT LEAST 2) ·

| CLASSMATE | THEIR QUESTION | MY ANSWER |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

## BEFORE I PRESENT ·

- ☐ Files named "Your Name – Music for Visual Media"; .mp3 or .wav and zipped .logicx uploaded
- ☐ Padlet post created with my 3 questions
- ☐ Rubric self-score done (page 21)

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## QUESTIONS?

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## CREDITS

- Project sheet, rubric, teacher notes and intro deck: original work by Brian Lotze, Hudson Beat.
- Worked example (an invented 90-second scene described on paper), the timeline, bars-and-seconds and dynamics drawings and layouts: original work, Hudson Beat.
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